

How Do We Know Something Is Alive? — Answer

Living Things • Level 3

A. Match each life process to the best example.

1. Grows

Answer: A puppy becomes a larger adult dog.

2. Reproduces

Answer: A bird produces chicks.

3. Responds

Answer: A sunflower bends toward light.

4. Uses energy

Answer: A child uses energy from food to run.

5. Exchanges gases

Answer: A fish takes oxygen from water.

6. Gets rid of waste

Answer: A person removes waste in urine.

B. Is this good evidence of life by itself? (Many non-living things can move or be warm!)

1. It gets bigger over time.

Answer: NO — non-living things can also get bigger (crystals, icicles, fire), so growth alone isn't enough.

2. It can move from place to place.

Answer: NO — non-living things move too (cars, clouds, rivers).

3. It produces offspring.

Answer: YES — reproduction is unique to living things, so this alone is reliable evidence.

4. It uses energy.

Answer: NO — non-living things use energy too (cars, machines, batteries).

5. It is warm.

Answer: NO — non-living things can be warm too (fire, engines, the Sun).

C. Why is movement alone NOT enough to prove that something is alive?

Answer: Because many non-living things — like cars, wind, clouds and rivers — can also move without being alive. Movement has to be combined with other life processes (growing, reproducing, using energy) before it counts as real evidence of life.